Solace-AI

KING'S College LONDON

INFORMATION SHEET

Co-Developing the DEEPER Evaluation Framework

Ethical Clearance Reference Number: MRA-25/26-55176

We would like to invite you to participate in this co-development study which forms part of the Solace-AI research project. Before you decide whether you want to take part, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what your participation will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish. Please feel free to ask us if there is anything that is not clear or if you would like more information. You can find our contact details at the end of this document.

What is the purpose of the project?

Solace-AI aims to generate real-time evidence synthesis to support policy and humanitarian responses to climate-change health emergencies. The purpose of this sub-study is to **co-develop** an evaluation framework for AI-powered deep research systems - DEEPER (Deep rEsearch Evaluation Protocol for Evidence Reviews).

Why have I been invited to take part?

You are being invited to participate because we have identified that you have expertise relevant to (automated evidence synthesis), applied artificial intelligence, evidence-based guideline development, and/or policy decision-making contexts.

What will happen if I take part?

If you choose to take part in the project you will be invited to:

1. Attend a **co-development workshop** where we will introduce the DEEPER framework concept and share our current thinking, draw on your expertise to design and refine the candidate framework items, and discuss how best to operationalise DEEPER for automated evidence synthesis. We will also launch our plans for a Delphi study and invite you to participate.
2. Participate in a **Delphi study** to refine candidate framework items to reach consensus on the final framework. This will involve completing up to three rounds of surveys. In the survey, you will be presented with a list of candidate evaluation domains and items and asked to indicate the degree to which you agree the candidate item should be included in the DEEPER framework, as well as whether you think the item should be renamed or reworded. You will also be given the opportunity to suggest any additional items.

Do I have to take part?

Participation is completely voluntary. You should only take part if you want to and choosing not to take part will not disadvantage you in any way. Once you have read the Information Sheet, please contact us if you have any questions that will help you make a decision about taking part.

What are the possible risks and benefits of taking part?

We do not foresee any negative impacts of participating in this co-design study. Your contributions will play an important role in identifying and refining candidate domains and items for a novel evaluation framework for AI-powered deep research systems. The framework itself will fill a vital gap in AI evaluation.

Data handling and confidentiality

King's College London is the Sponsor of this research and is responsible for looking after your information.

We will need to use information from you for this research project. The research team and authorised administrative staff will use this information to do the research or to check your records to make sure that the research is being done properly.

Your data will be processed in compliance with UK data protection laws, including the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018.

Categories of Personal Data	We will collect your name, contact details, geographical region, and the name of the organisation you work for.
Data Storage	Any electronic data (e.g., recordings, questionnaire data) will be stored electronically on a King's College London network with restricted access to only the Solace-AI research team.
Data Sharing	Data will only be shared only with members of the Solace-AI team. We will not share your contact details (e.g., name, email address or phone number) with any third parties.
International Data Sharing	Contact details may be shared with international members of the Solace-AI team for the purposes of communicating with you and organising meetings, but will not be shared any further.
Data Retention	Data will be held for 10 years (in line with King's College London policy), and you have the right of access to your records at any time.
Research Outputs	The outcomes of this project will be published, but your identity and individual contributions will be confidential.
Archiving/Future Use	We retain your contact details until the end of the project and we will use them to communicate with you throughout.

Further information on how King's processes research data can be found at: https://www.kcl.ac.uk/research/support/research-ethics/kings-college-london-statement-on-use-of-personal-data-in-research

Please contact the research team if you require further information on data processing or a printed version of the webpage link above.

What if I change my mind about taking part?

You are free to withdraw at any point of the project, without having to give a reason. You can let us know by emailing or writing to us. Withdrawing from the project will not affect you in any way. Any data collected prior to withdrawal will be retained.

How is the project being funded?

This project is being funded by the Wellcome Trust [grant number: 313618/Z/24/Z].

What will happen to the results of the project?

The results of the project will be summarised in academic articles, publicly available materials on the Solace-AI website, and in presentations (e.g., seminars, conferences). Your identity and individual contributions will not be identifiable in any research outputs.

Who should I contact for further information?

If you have any questions or require more information about this project, please contact us using the following contact details:

Principal Investigator: Dr Iain Marshall
Email: iain.marshall@kcl.ac.uk
Address: King's College London, Department of Population Health Sciences, 3rd Floor Addison House, London, SE1 1UL

What if I have further questions, or if something goes wrong?

If this project has harmed you in any way, or if you wish to make a complaint about the conduct of the project you can contact King's College London using the details below for further advice and information:

Research Ethics Office
Email: rec@kcl.ac.uk
Address: King's College London, Research Ethics Office, 3rd Floor, 5-11 Lavington Street, London, SE1 0NZ

Thank you for reading this information sheet and for considering taking part in this research.